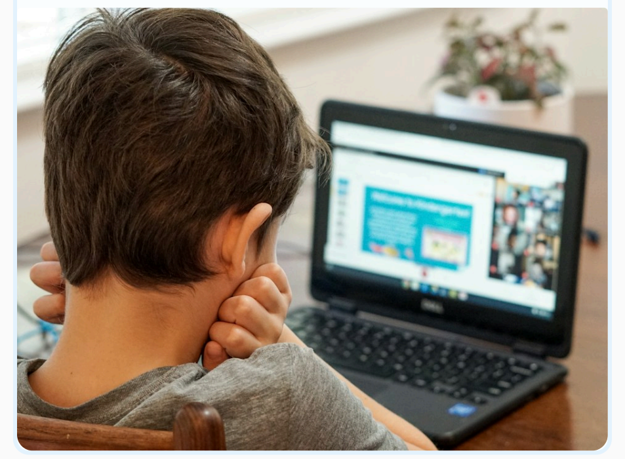
SCIS Student Journey: Final Year to Graduation and Employment

smaply

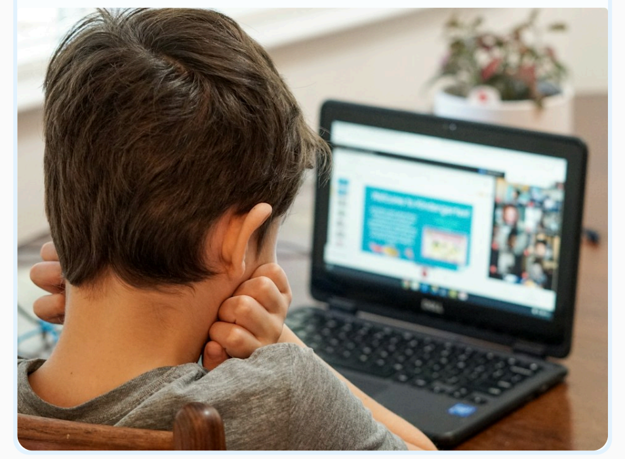
Description

Persona: Marcus Tan, Year 4 SMU SCIS Information Systems student. Scenario: from the start of final year to a job offer and graduation. Expectation: "SCIS gets me employed and graduates me on time." Channels: Email, Telegram, LinkedIn, Phone, Face to face.
Stage A – Set up final year (Jul–Sep)
1. Plan the final year: runs degree audit, bids for final modules in BOSS, forms capstone team. Thinks "Do I have everything I need to graduate?" Emotion 0. Pain: audit info spread across portals; advisor takes ~1 week to reply. Opportunity: one audit checklist confirmed by Week 3.
2. Capstone kickoff: matched with industry sponsor, scopes problem. Emotion +1. Pain: sponsor slow to share data. Opportunity: sponsor data-readiness checklist.
Stage B – Job hunt (Sep–Nov)
3. Recruitment season: career fair, 40+ applications, online assessments. Thinks "Everyone's hiring bankers, not PMs." Emotion -1. Pain: few product roles; assessments clash with project deadlines. Opportunity: product/analytics employer sessions.
4. Interviews vs coursework: final-round interview clashes with graded presentation. Emotion -1. Pain: no clear rule on interview absences. Opportunity: interview-leave form with 48-hour reply.
Stage C – Prove it (Nov)
5. Capstone showcase: demos to sponsor and faculty; sponsor invites him to interview. Thinks "This is why I came to SCIS." Emotion +2, BEST experience. Opportunity: recruit more sponsors with hiring intent.
Stage D – Finish and leave (Jan–mid-year)
6. Final term and graduation audit: late audit flags a missing requirement; needed module is full in BOSS while his job offer depends on graduating. Thinks "Why am I only finding out now?" Emotion -2, WORST experience. Opportunity: early-warning audit and reserved seats for graduating students.
7. Graduate and become alumni: commencement, starts work, joins alumni list. Emotion +1. Pain: generic alumni emails. Opportunity: alumni mentoring for Year 3–4s.
Behind the scenes: academic advising, registrar, capstone office, career centre, faculty, alumni office.

Journey Stages High-level stages of the customer journey	Set up final year (Jul–Sep)		
Journey Steps Detailed steps within each journey stage	Plan final year	Form capstone team	Capstone kickoff
Actions	**ACTIONS** Marcus runs a degree audit in the portal and bids for his final modules in the BOSS system. • Do I actually have everything I need to graduate (assumption, validate)? Check BOSS bidding rules first.	**ACTIONS** Marcus coordinates with classmates to form a capstone project team and align on system development interests. • I need to find a team that is committed to the same technical stack.	**ACTIONS** The team is matched with an industry sponsor, scopes the problem, and requests project data. • Finally, real work with a real company.
Pain points	**PAIN POINT** Audit info is spread across multiple portals and the academic advisor takes over a week to reply.		**PAIN POINT** The industry sponsor is slow to share data, causing two weeks of project time to be lost.
Journey Storyboard	**PLAN FINAL YEAR** 	**FORM CAPSTONE TEAM** 	**CAPSTONE KICKOFF**
Channels	**CHANNELS** BOSS Portal Email	**CHANNELS** Telegram In Person	**CHANNELS** Face to Face Email

Journey Stages High-level stages of the customer journey	Job hunt (Sep–Nov)		
Journey Steps Detailed steps within each journey stage	Recruitment season	Online assessments	Interviews vs coursework
Actions	**ACTIONS** Marcus attends the campus career fair and submits over 40 job applications online. • Everyone here is hiring bankers, not PMs.	**ACTIONS** Marcus sits for multiple online technical assessments and coding tests required by employers. • These assessments are taking up all my project coding time.	**ACTIONS** A final-round job interview clashes directly with a graded team presentation. • Do I risk my grade or the job?
Pain points	**PAIN POINT** There are very few product manager roles available at the career fair.	**PAIN POINT** Online assessments pile up heavily during peak academic project deadlines.	**PAIN POINT** There is no clear school policy on interview absences, leaving decisions entirely to the professor.
Journey Storyboard	**RECRUITMENT SEASON** 	**ONLINE ASSESSMENTS** 	**INTERVIEWS VS COURSEWORK**
Channels	**CHANNELS** Career Fair LinkedIn	**CHANNELS** Web Portal Email	**CHANNELS** Email Phone Call

Journey Stages High-level stages of the customer journey	Prove it (Nov)		
Journey Steps Detailed steps within each journey stage	Capstone development	Sponsor review	Capstone showcase
Actions	**ACTIONS** Marcus and his team build out the prototype and integrate feedback from the academic advisor. • We need to make sure this solution actually works for their system.	**ACTIONS** The team presents their interim progress to the industry sponsor for validation. • I hope the sponsor is satisfied with our progress so far.	**ACTIONS** Marcus demos the completed solution to the sponsor and faculty, earning an immediate interview invite. • This is why I came to SCIS.
Pain points			**PAIN POINT** Many showcase sponsors attend only for grading rather than active talent recruitment.
Journey Storyboard	**CAPSTONE DEVELOPMENT** 	**SPONSOR REVIEW** 	**CAPSTONE SHOWCASE**
Channels	**CHANNELS** GitHub Lab Meetings	**CHANNELS** Face to Face Email	**CHANNELS** Face to Face LinkedIn

Journey Stages High-level stages of the customer journey	Finish & leave (Jan–mid-year)		
Journey Steps Detailed steps within each journey stage	Final term audit	Scramble for appeal	Graduate & become alumni
Actions	**ACTIONS** A late graduation audit flags a missing requirement, while the needed module is already full in BOSS. • My job offer depends on graduating. Why am I only finding out now?	**ACTIONS** Marcus files urgent appeals and contacts academic advisors to secure a module seat. • I can't let a single module ruin my job offer.	**ACTIONS** Marcus attends commencement, starts his new job, and is added to the alumni mailing list. • Relieved. Proud, mostly.
Pain points	**PAIN POINT** Late audits flag missing requirements when the required module is already full in BOSS.	**PAIN POINT** The manual appeal process is slow and lacks transparency during a high-stakes period.	**PAIN POINT** Alumni emails are generic, unengaging, and quickly ignored by new graduates.
Journey Storyboard	**FINAL TERM AUDIT** 	**SCRAMBLE FOR APPEAL** 	**GRADUATE & BECOME ALUMNI**
Channels	**CHANNELS** Email Phone Call	**CHANNELS** Advising Office Email	**CHANNELS** Commencement Email LinkedIn

Emotion chart